

mentor Bhansali but catch him ever calling him anything but boss (or genius). But it doesn't always work. For instance, Muzammil Ibrahim got a dream debut, at least on paper, with Pooja Bhatt's *Dhoka*, but quickly fell out with her. The falling out, as such things do, made news for precisely one-and-a-half seconds before both the controversy and the film vanished. The mentoring didn't help even Nikhil Dwivedi, who found a famous supporter in Shah Rukh Khan when he was working with Videocon, but impressed no one else in his debut film, *My Name is Anthony Gonsalves*, which was produced, marketed and pushed by the superstar's own company.

4. Obsess about your appearance This is a characteristic even of ageing boylets such as Viveik Oberoi, who went from hairy to scary recently, and was seen in public with suspiciously plucked eyebrows, waxed chest and lip gloss—it's a global trend, we know, with Zac Efron leading the way. But hey, he's 20 and last we checked Oberoi (an alumnus of the trophy girlfriend club) is 31. Ranbir, with his hair-over-forehead-or-hair brushed-back, is a new addition, as is Kunal Kapoor who makes news for shaving (or not) and remaining lean (or not).

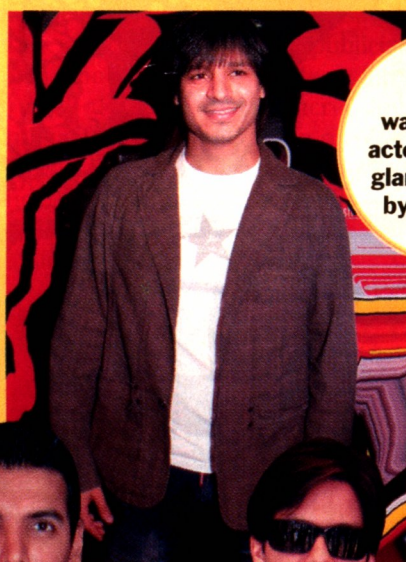
5. Reform your party hearty ways The rat packs are out. Wild girls may be all the rage in Hollywood but in India it pays to reform. Sikander Kher, who is currently more famous for being Abhishek Bachchan's best buddy, is a prime example. The long-haired, long-limbed actor who is set to make his debut this year was well known for late nights and loud fights before he decided to buckle up. Even boylets like Mimoh (as in son of Mithun Chakrabarty), who try to attend as many dos as they can,

INTO THE BOYZONE

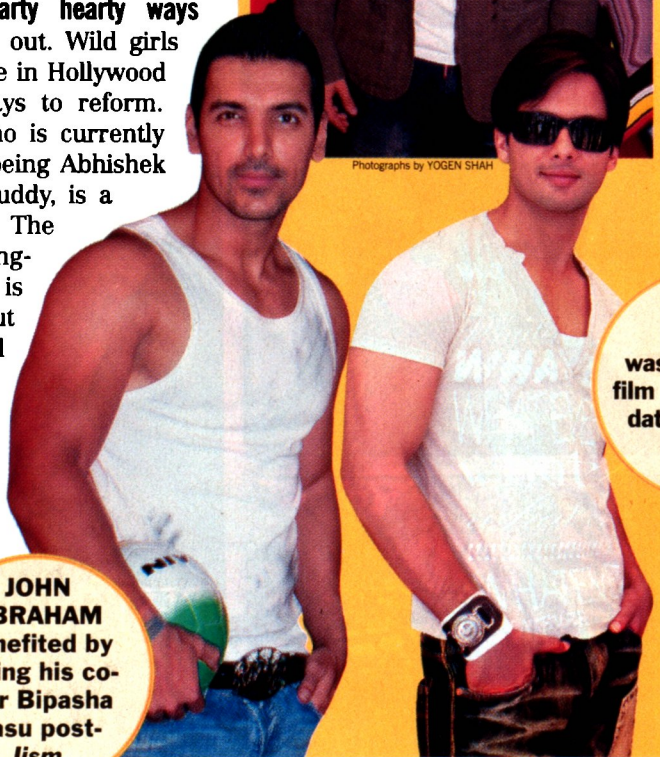
Boylets have an honourable tradition of making news for dating the right girl



DINO MOREA
Former model, dated model and co-star Bipasha Basu



VIVEIK OBEROI
was a serious actor till he was glamour-struck by Aishwarya Rai



JOHN ABRAHAM
benefited by dating his co-star Bipasha Basu post-Jism

SHAHID KAPUR
was just a one-film hit before he dated Kareena Kapoor

tend to behave themselves.

6. Go out on not so-discreet dates These involve walking hand-in-hand at film premieres, dining out at any restaurant in media hangout J.W. Marriott in Mumbai and working out at a well-known gym in the stretch between Andheri and Bandra. If the media doesn't see you, make sure they hear of it. So we know Shahid is one day organising a trial show for Amrita Rao, another day driving with Vidya Balan and yet another day going out for dinner with Sania Mirza. Usually the denials to these events occur before the actual events are reported.

7. Deny "link-ups" This is usually practised by boylets such as Shiny Ahuja, who tends to be linked to almost every co-star he has acted with. The charade usually follows this route: story breaks out, actor denies it, his publicist threatens a law suit, repeatedly.

8. Find a male buddy It could be Aashish Choudhury who hangs out with director Sanjay Gupta and company, or Sikander Kher who has known Bachchan Junior from even before *Refugee*. The friendships may not be designed to benefit the boylet but the additional visibility does help.

9. Go to the right school This is almost as important as going to the right gym and drinking the right protein shake. School friendships last forever. Look at Rohan Sippy's association with his Aiglon junior Abhishek Bachchan. Sometimes it could even be the right acting school—like Mukesh who did a course at Anupam Kher's acting academy at the same time as the much older and famous Abhishek and Hrithik Roshan.

10. Terminal TMI Too much information (TMI). Mukesh was a blonde baby. Ranbir practised action scenes in his garden. The most free with information about their chest size and follicle growth are models turned wannabe actors such as Ibrahim and Patel who have already braced the sexism of the modelling world (boys are background, the girls sell the shows). This is the price of fame, column inch by column inch. ■

Photographs by YOGEN SHAH